

Figure 10. Nagarjuna Sagar Lake

I have time to kill before the last ferry. I wander to the transplanted third-century Ikshvaku ghat, a fitting place to rest and imagine the city at its prime: its street life, homes, people. What was Nagarjuna like as a man, in the eyes of his family and friends? How sophisticated must the city's intellectual culture have been to bubble up a thinker like him. What was it like to engage in doctrinal debates, where rival schools of thought battled each other? I sit and wonder, absently staring at a lake so large that it sends small waves crashing at my feet.